

Committee Meeting



Simulation Procedure



During the committee meeting, the chair will lead proceedings. The Minister of Food and witnesses will each deliver short presentations, explaining their positions on the bill. Senators will ask questions after each presentation to better understand the positions and implications of the bill. The chair will lead committee members on a clause-by-clause examination of the bill before amendments are suggested and the bill is voted on.

The steps for the simulation are laid out below. The chair should refer to their script (located in their student package) to lead proceedings.

I. Chair introductions

🕒 02 min

- The **chair** begins the meeting by welcoming everyone and explaining proceedings.

II. Cabinet minister presentation

🕒 05 min

- The **Minister of Food** will speak first to introduce and explain the bill.
- This will be followed by a question-and-answer session.
- **Committee members** may ask the minister questions.
- **Committee members** may also comment on the bill during question-and-answer time.

III. Witness presentations

🕒 20 min

- There will be three presentations by **witnesses** who represent groups that are interested in this bill.
- After each **witness**, the **chair** will allow **committee members** to ask questions of the **witnesses** and make comments.

IV. Clause-by-clause examination of the bill and amendments

🕒 20 min

- The **chair** leads the committee through each clause in the main part of the bill, starting with clause 4.
- For each clause, the **chair** asks if there is any discussion. At that point **committee members** may speak in favour of or against the wording of the clause under discussion.
- At the end of each discussion, the **chair** calls for a vote on that clause.



Suggested amendments

- Only a **committee member** can propose an amendment, although an amendment can be drafted by an external group (such as the **witnesses**) and brought forward by a **committee member**.
- If you have an amendment, wait until the **chair** begins the discussion of that clause. Put up your hand, and when the **chair** calls on you, say: "Mr./Madam/Mx. Chair, I would propose an amendment to this clause."
- Read out your new wording and pass the amendment paper to the **Clerk** (your teacher). The **chair** will ask you to speak in favour of the amendment.
- The **chair** will then ask for other committee members in favour of or against the amendment. At this time, members may also propose changes to the amendment being discussed.
- The **chair** calls for a vote on whether or not to approve the amendment to the clause.
- If the amendment passes the vote, the **Clerk** changes the wording of the amended clause and the **chair** reads out the new wording.
- After the vote on the amendment, the **chair** calls for a vote on the clause. If there are other amendments to be proposed, they should be moved at this time. **Note: Only one amendment may be discussed at a time.*
- Once a clause — with or without amendment — has been approved, the committee may begin its discussion of the next clause.

V. Vote to report the bill

🕒 03 min

- The final step for the committee meeting is to vote on whether or not to adopt the bill and to report the bill to the Senate as it is now written.
- If you approve of adopting the bill as it is now written, after any amendments have been made, vote "Yes." If you oppose it as written, vote "No."
- If you approve that the bill should be reported to the Senate, vote "Yes." If you oppose that it should be reported, vote "No."

